WE ARE M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

Rakuten

RAKUTEN: WORKING WITH CREATORS

Rakuten is one of the leading Cash Back and shopping rewards apps in the U.S. Members can access over 3,500 retailers across every shopping category, including big brands like Nike, Adidas, Sephora, ULTA Beauty, Levi's, Calvin Klein, Target, Walmart, and more.

The app is simple to use – users simply click through stores on the Rakuten app and then shop on the site as normal. After completing a purchase, the Cash Back gets added to their account balance. Shoppers can earn up to 15% Cash Back on product purchased via Rakuten depending on the deals available.

Rakuten became a client for M&C Saatchi Performance in 2021, at that time a new Influencer Performance Marketing division was established at the agency to help clients such as Rakuten harness the power of content creators via performance media channels.

At M&C Saatchi Performance, we believe finding the right partnerships for creating effective content goes beyond a follower count. Initial Rakuten campaigns focused solely on influencers but now we're successfully running a blend of influencers and UGC creators to tap into a wider and more diverse pool of creators, allowing our campaigns to scale and be more relatable.

This approach has proven so successful for Rakuten that it has become an evergreen performance media strategy for the brand. The M&C Saatchi Performance team are now so trusted, they create new approaches based on seasonality and trends seen on TikTok to continue keeping the brand relevant even during times when consumer spending may be low.

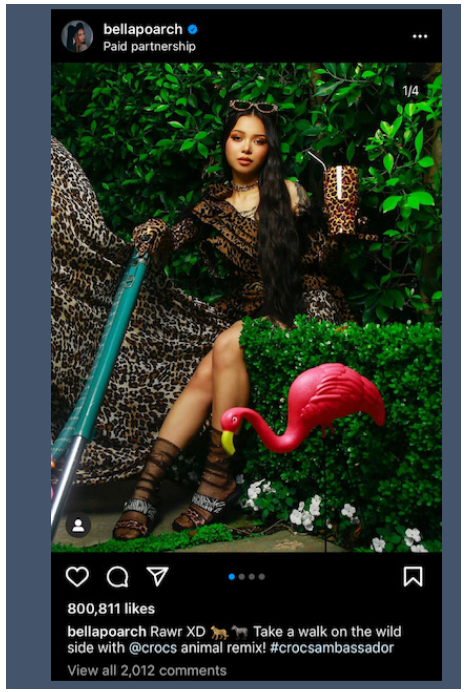
INFLUENCERS VS CREATORS

Although both influencers and creators both create content, there are differences between the two groups.

INFLUENCER

Influencers are best used when the goal is to reach a specific audience through the voice of the creator. The partnership helps drive awareness and trust by borrowing their equity – thus, driving influence over their audience.

The most effective campaigns are customized to match each influencer and allow for creative freedom. This enables an authentic integration that resonates with consumers.



CONTENT CREATOR

Content creators are a great resource for generating assets using the expertise of the creator. This allows brands to experiment with different types of content and make ads appear more native.

Similar to influencers, creators can be sourced based on category, geo, age, and gender but content can feature actors in place of real people and the goal isn't necessarily to influence the creator's audience.

M&C SAATCHI PERFORMANCE

ONGOING CREATIVE TESTING

THE BRIEF:

Drive ongoing app installs and new users

THE CHALLENGE:

Deliver engaging content that will resonate with target audiences and explain the benefits of Rakuten effectively.

Competitors such as Fetch Rewards and Ibotta are competing for eyeballs on Cash Back and reward apps.

THE STRATEGY:

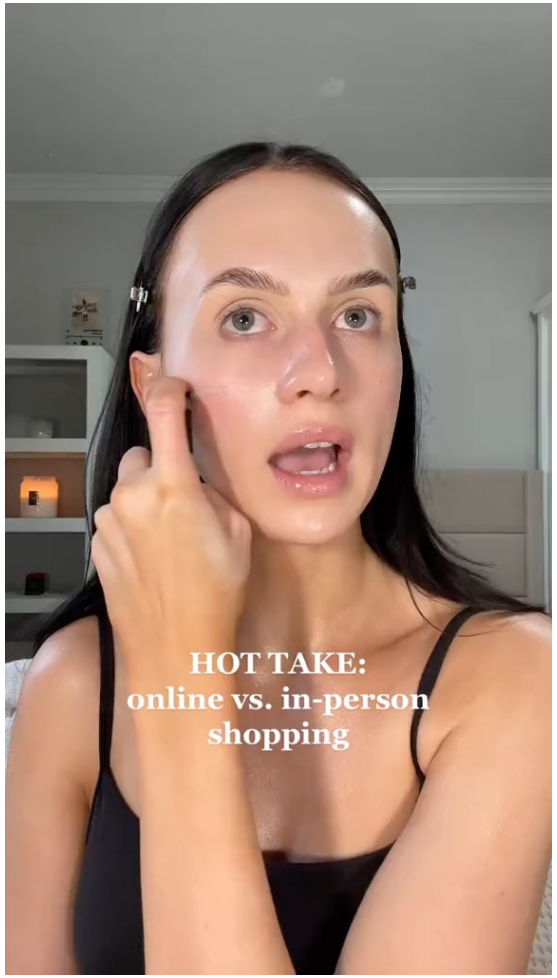
The M&C Saatchi Performance team have developed a structured approach to testing that has led to a virtuous feedback loop for Rakuten, ensuring ongoing efficiencies are delivered. We are highly structured and process driven which has enabled Rakuten to test & learn from many campaigns.

Micro-influencers are chosen based on their ability to deliver high quality content and their authority to speak on key shopping categories available on Rakuten. Categories such pets, clothing, health & beauty, and household essential items have all been tested over several months to see where the highest performance is delivered. Content is then boosted with paid media to extend the reach of our campaigns.

UGC creators are also added to campaigns to represent and resonate with everyday consumers, people who are looking to save money on products they need or use more frequently such as beauty and household items. We developed a messaging strategy that clearly communicates the value of the app while also providing an element of social proof. Creator videos are uploaded to Rakuten's ad account and are closely monitored during testing. Those that perform within Rakuten's goals are scaled up, others are optimized for continued testing or are paused.

'Household essentials' videos have delivered consistent and efficient cost per install results. The category was suggested by the M&C Saatchi Performance team due to the rising cost of everyday items and has proven relevant to the Rakuten audience.

EXAMPLES OF CREATOR CONTENT:



IMPRESSIONS: >8.3 M

IMPRESSIONS: >6.5M

IMPRESSIONS: >22M

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Rakuten

RESULTS:

-35%

REDUCTION IN COST PER INSTALL

-33%

REDUCTION IN COST PER SIGN UP

+127%

INCREASE IN CLICK TO INSTALL

Results: Q2 compared to Q1, 2023

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TALK TO US

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Rakuten

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